

Neurology Service Line Handbook

Meridian Health Partners - Neurology Service Line Handbook

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1.0 Purpose and Scope

1.1 This handbook outlines the operational parameters for the Neurology service line at Meridian Health Partners (MHP) outpatient clinics.

1.2 It serves as a guide for MHP staff, referring providers, and patients regarding the services offered, operational expectations, and patient engagement protocols within the Neurology department.

1.3 This document does not provide clinical diagnostic or treatment guidance.

2.0 Accepted and Non-Accepted Conditions

2.1 The MHP Neurology department accepts referrals for the management of the following stable neurological conditions:

2.1.1 Headaches, including migraine, tension-type headaches, and cluster headaches.

2.1.2 Epilepsy and seizure disorders (excluding acute status epilepticus).

2.1.3 Movement disorders, including Parkinson's disease, essential tremor, and dystonia.

2.1.4 Multiple Sclerosis (MS) and other demyelinating diseases (for stable, chronic management).

2.1.5 Peripheral neuropathies.

2.1.6 Stroke follow-up and post-stroke management (post-acute phase, stable condition).

2.1.7 Dementia and cognitive impairment (for initial assessment and stable management).

2.1.8 Radiculopathy and common entrapment neuropathies (e.g., carpal tunnel syndrome).

2.2 The MHP Neurology department explicitly does not accept referrals for:

2.2.1 Acute stroke or suspected transient ischemic attack (TIA) requiring emergency evaluation. Such cases must be directed to an Emergency Department.

2.2.2 Active status epilepticus or uncontrolled, life-threatening seizures. Such cases must be directed to an Emergency Department.

2.2.3 Severe traumatic brain injury (TBI) requiring immediate neurosurgical or critical care intervention.

2.2.4 Rapidly progressive neuromuscular diseases requiring inpatient or intensive care unit (ICU) level management.

2.2.5 Pediatric neurology cases for patients under 16 years of age. These referrals must be directed to specialized pediatric neurology services.

2.2.6 Conditions requiring inpatient admission at the time of referral (e.g., acute encephalitis, meningitis).

3.0 Appointment Duration

3.1 Initial Neurology consultations are allocated a typical duration of 60 minutes.

3.2 Follow-up Neurology appointments are allocated a typical duration of 30 minutes.

3.3 Specific procedures, such as nerve conduction studies or Botox injections, may require additional time beyond the standard follow-up slot, as scheduled by the Neurology scheduling coordinator.

4.0 Patient Preparation Instructions

4.1 Patients referred to the MHP Neurology department shall receive the following standard preparation instructions:

4.1.1 Medication List: Patients must bring a comprehensive list of all current medications, including dosages and frequency, or the medications themselves in their original containers.

4.1.2 Medical Records: Patients are advised to bring any relevant prior medical records, including imaging reports (e.g., MRI, CT scans), laboratory results, and previous neurologist notes.

4.1.3 Arrival Time: Patients are required to arrive at the clinic 15 minutes prior to their scheduled appointment time to complete necessary registration and administrative paperwork.

4.1.4 Comfortable Attire: Patients should wear comfortable, loose-fitting clothing to facilitate a thorough neurological examination.

4.1.5 Transportation: For appointments where procedures involving sedation or requiring specific post-procedure precautions are anticipated, patients will be specifically advised to arrange for an escort or alternative transportation.

5.0 Meridian Health Partners Plan Coverage for Neurology Services

5.1 MHP offers four primary health plans. Coverage for common Neurology services is detailed below:

5.1.1 Neurology Consultation (Initial & Follow-up):

5.1.1.1 Meridian BasicCare: Covered, standard co-pay applies.

5.1.1.2 Meridian FlexChoice: Covered, standard co-pay applies.

5.1.1.3 Meridian Prime: Covered, no co-pay.

5.1.1.4 Meridian ElitePlus: Covered, no co-pay.

5.1.2 Electroencephalogram (EEG):

5.1.2.1 Meridian BasicCare: Covered, 80% after deductible.

5.1.2.2 Meridian FlexChoice: Covered, 90% after deductible.

5.1.2.3 Meridian Prime: Covered, 100% after deductible.

5.1.2.4 Meridian ElitePlus: Covered, 100%, no deductible.

5.1.3 Electromyography (EMG) and Nerve Conduction Studies (NCS):

5.1.3.1 Meridian BasicCare: Covered, 80% after deductible. Prior authorization required.

5.1.3.2 Meridian FlexChoice: Covered, 90% after deductible.

5.1.3.3 Meridian Prime: Covered, 100% after deductible.

5.1.3.4 Meridian ElitePlus: Covered, 100%, no deductible.

5.1.4 Botox Injections for Chronic Migraine:

5.1.4.1 Meridian BasicCare: Not covered.

5.1.4.2 Meridian FlexChoice: Covered, 50% co-pay applies after deductible.

5.1.4.3 Meridian Prime: Covered, 20% co-pay applies after deductible.

5.1.4.4 Meridian ElitePlus: Covered, 100% after deductible.

5.1.5 Lumbar Puncture (Procedure):

5.1.5.1 Meridian BasicCare: Covered, 70% after deductible. Prior authorization required.

5.1.5.2 Meridian FlexChoice: Covered, 80% after deductible.

5.1.5.3 Meridian Prime: Covered, 90% after deductible.

5.1.5.4 Meridian ElitePlus: Covered, 100%, no deductible.

5.2 Patients are advised to confirm specific coverage details with their plan administrator prior to their appointment.

6.0 Referral Turnaround Commitment

6.1 The MHP Neurology department commits to processing all incoming referrals within 48 business hours of electronic receipt via the MHP Centralized Referral System.

6.2 Referring providers will receive confirmation of referral receipt and an estimated appointment

timeline within this 48-hour period.

6.3 Urgent referrals, as designated by the referring provider and meeting MHP's internal urgency criteria (Appendix A), will be reviewed by the on-call neurologist within 24 business hours.

7.0 Contact Information

7.1 For operational inquiries regarding the Neurology service line, please contact Ms. Clara Jenkins, Neurology Department Coordinator, at (555) 123-4567 ext. 789.

7.2 For clinical questions, referring providers may contact the Neurology on-call service at (555) 987-6543.